Day 28 - Terra Cotta

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Toronto section · hike 36 · Terra Cotta

11.2 km / 7.0 mi	~3.1 h	5.5 km new	45 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive each way, Sat 7 am

Park (P): Roadside parking where the main Trail meets Heritage Rd. Please do not block access to the gate. Google Maps. **Free**

Navigate: import *day28_hike036.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Terra Cotta Side Trail (5.5 km)

Route map



What to expect

- **Parking:** Roadside where the main trail meets Heritage Rd. Please do not block the gate.
- **Main Bruce Trail:** Through Terra Cotta Conservation Area the main trail follows the Escarpment Trail, a steep climb through sugar maple forest to escarpment views, past seasonal vernal pools, and the Graydon Trail, which CVC calls isolated and rugged in places. Dog walking is listed on both.
- **Terra Cotta Conservation Area:** Drive-in visitors pay a gate fee (adults $8.50); hours are 8 a.m. to 7 p.m. Park highlights include Wolf Lake and a wetland boardwalk.
- **Terra Cotta Side Trail:** No description of the side trail itself was found. Follow the blue blazes and the guide's directions.

- **Road walking:** A stretch of the Terra Cotta Side Trail and the final stretch of the main trail follow a road shoulder; keep Zappy close and walk single file facing traffic.

Parking options

	Alternative parking	Parking cost	Route km	Walk to trail	Closest side trails
P2	Roadside parking on Winston Churchill Blvd where the Terra Cotta Side Trail crosses the road map	Free	3.9	470 m	Terra Cotta
P3	Roadside parking on Tenth Line, 2.2 km southeast of 32 Sideroad (Halton Road 42) map	Free	6.0	840 m	
P4	Off road parking, located on a very short dirt road off of Winston Churchill Blvd just south... map	Free	9.3	170 m	
P5	Terra Cotta Conservation Area: Parking is available off Winston Churchill Blvd within the... map	Paid: $8.50 per adult admission (+HST); no separate vehicle fee listed	9.3	780 m	

Can't do it all in one go? Split it into two shorter outings: **Outing 1** from the planned parking (P): 7.8 km / 4.9 mi, covering Terra Cotta. **Outing 2** from P2 (Roadside parking on Winston Churchill Blvd where the Terra Cotta Side Trail crosses the road; Free): 5.1 km / 3.2 mi, covering Terra Cotta. The website's map shows which parts are already done.

Parking costs were checked in October 2026 from operator websites and Bruce Trail Conservancy data; prices and booking rules change, so check before you go.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Roadside parking where the main Trail meets Heritage Rd. Head north-east on the white-blazed main Bruce Trail.
0.5	0.3	J1: Continue straight onto the blue-blazed Terra Cotta Side Trail, heading north. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
1.6	1.0	Heads-up: The next 0.7 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
6.0	3.7	J2: Continue straight onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.)
10.8	6.7	J3: Junction. Turn right to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading south-east. (the blue-blazed Rockside Side Trail goes off on your left (optional extra: Rockside Side Trail, 1.7 km, mostly on road, not in the plan).) The next 0.4 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
11.2	7.0	Back at the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on Credit Valley Conservation and a Vanderplas family trip report.